

Where to Go: Erie Extension Canal Towpath Trail

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- **What to do:** Your driving tour follows state Route 285 in Crawford County parallel to the route of a controversial part of the Erie Canal. The main canal was considered an engineering marvel when it was completed in 1825, linking the Hudson River to Lake Erie and opening an efficient trade route to the American West. A decade after its opening, demand grew for a direct link from the canal to the Ohio River and the Pennsylvania Main Line railroad. Construction of the Erie Extension Canal was completed 1844. The tow path crossed five northwestern Pennsylvania counties and connected the Ohio River to Lake Erie. Competitors from the railroad industry are suspected of destroying a vital aqueduct 1873.

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